ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Victor Canning	Victor Canning wrote it.
2	**(b)** open the safe because she had lost the key	She wanted her jewels.
3	**(a)** believed the stranger easily	He trusted too readily.
4	**(c)** making locks and safes	He made locks for a living.
5	**(c)** believed her story and wanted to be a good person	He trusted her.
6	**(a)** do not trust a stranger blindly	Misplaced trust.
7	**(d)** rare books	Rare books were his passion.
8	**(c)** another thief	She was herself a burglar.
9	**(d)** Horace's trust in the woman	Trust is central.
10	**(a)** once a year	He robbed one house each year.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Horace Danby was a respectable maker of locks and safes (1) who secretly burgled a house once a year to buy rare books (1).	1+1
12	She said she had forgotten the key of the safe (1) and needed her jewels for a party (1).	1+1
13	She said she knew nothing of the man (1) and had never met the young woman (1).	1+1
14	He loved rare books which were very costly (1) and he stole to afford the one he wanted that year (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Horace is a middle-aged, respected lock-maker who lives a quiet life. His only passion is collecting rare books. To get money for one he plans a single robbery every year.	1+1+1
16	Horace is put in jail but finds the prison library. He is given work as the librarian and reads the books. He is quite happy there.	1+1+1
17	Horace's sneezing, politeness during a burglary and the ironic prison library are comic. Humour comes from his innocence. The tone remains light.	1+1+1
	OR: He wanted to steal only once a year and avoid capture. He studied the house and chose a day when the owner would be away. Careful planning had kept him free so far.	1+1+1
18	Do not trust anyone blindly, especially in suspicious situations. Appearances may deceive. Even honest persons can be misled by smooth talk.	1+1+1
	OR: The woman said that she had lost her key. 'I' becomes 'she' and 'have lost' becomes 'had lost'.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	A respectable maker of locks and safes (1). A passionate book collector (1). A once-a-year burglar (1). Kind and gullible (1). Ends as a prison librarian (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He chose a house and a day (1). He prepared his tools (1). A cold and a visitor spoiled it (1). He left fingerprints (1). He was caught (1).	2+2+1
20	She appears as the lady of the house (1). She says she lost her key (1). She asks him to open the safe (1). She takes the jewels (1). Horace is arrested later (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). Memory of the night (1). Regret at trusting (1). Thoughts about books (1). Closing reflection (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Horace Danby a professional thief; he is a **respectable locksmith** who steals once a year to buy rare books.

- Writing that Horace opened the safe at the Grange for his own plan; he opened it for the **young lady** who tricked him with a false story.
- Saying the lady was the owner's wife; she was a **thief** in disguise, while the real wife was a grey-haired woman of sixty.
- Missing the clue of his **fingerprints**: he took off his gloves to give her the lighter and opened the safe without them.
- Stating the title's meaning wrongly: the 'question of trust' is whether to trust a stranger; Horace trusted too easily and was *caught*.
- Spelling slips: *Horace Danby, locksmith, Shotover Grange, fingerprints, hay fever*; and 'honour among thieves'.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** the jewels	She took the jewels.
2	**(a)** an honest-looking person turns out a thief	Appearance versus reality.
3	**(d)** to buy expensive rare books	He needed money for his hobby.
4	**(c)** his fingerprints were found at the place	Fingerprints led them to him.
5	**(c)** a strong room for valuables	A secure place.
6	**(a)** a bad cold	He was sneezing.
7	**(c)** a thief was tricked by another thief	He was cheated by a cleverer thief.
8	**(b)** his love of rare books	It drove him to crime.
9	**(d)** Shotover Grange	The Grange was owned by a rich owner.
10	**(d)** librarian	He worked in the prison library.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He believed she was the owner's wife (1) and wished to help, so he trusted her (1).	1+1
12	That the young woman was herself a thief (1) who had used him to open the safe (1).	1+1
13	He had a bad cold and kept sneezing (1) and this made his work harder and risked giving him away (1).	1+1
14	The young woman took the jewels and left (1) and Horace went away thinking nothing was wrong (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She appeared calm and confident and spoke as the lady of the house. She gave a believable reason, the lost key and the party. Her friendly manner convinced him.	1+1+1
16	He is a gentle, polite man who loves books and wants to help. Yet he is a thief who breaks the law. The mixture makes him a humorous and sympathetic figure.	1+1+1
17	Horace was a locksmith. He opened the safe in the house.	1+1+1
	OR: He left his fingerprints in the house. He also trusted a stranger because of her story. These mistakes led to his arrest.	1+1+1
18	Horace's cold makes him sneeze, which adds humour and risk. The cold shows that his careful plans are not perfect. It also makes him seem harmless.	1+1+1
	OR: The burglar entered at night. The jewels were in the safe. The police found his fingerprints.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Horace plans his yearly burglary (1). He enters the Grange with a cold (1). A woman asks him to open the safe (1). She takes the jewels (1). He is caught and becomes a librarian (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Heading (1). Where you were (1). You say you did not know Horace (1). Describe missing jewels (1). Request action (1).	2+2+1
20	Horace trusts a stranger (1). He opens the safe (1). The woman is a thief (1). He is caught (1). Hence blind trust is dangerous (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Horace surprised (1). Woman's story (1). Horace's agreement (1). She leaves (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Spelling slips: *Horace Danby, locksmith, Shotover Grange, fingerprints, hay fever*; and 'honour among thieves'.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** suspicion	Suspicion.
2	**(d)** the owner was away and the staff were off	He had planned carefully.
3	**(c)** he enjoyed the books and felt content	He loved reading.
4	**(d)** the young woman	She took the jewels.
5	**(a)** a young woman	A young woman entered.
6	**(d)** a person who breaks into a house to steal	Burglar = house-breaker.
7	**(b)** kind-hearted and gullible	He trusted her story too easily.
8	**(c)** the owner's wife	She claimed to be the lady of the house.
9	**(d)** Horace was cheated by the woman.	Past simple passive.
10	**(a)** past perfect	had + V3.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He worked as a prison librarian (1) and enjoyed reading in peace (1).	1+1
12	A young woman appeared (1) and said she was the lady of the house (1).	1+1
13	His fingerprints were found in the house (1) and the police traced him through them (1).	1+1
14	A careful thief is tricked by another thief (1) and a man who lived by locks is fooled by a smooth story (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She regarded him as a useful tool. She played the part of owner with ease. She had no pity for him and took the jewels.	1+1+1
16	The story is about trust: Horace trusts the woman, and she exploits it. It also asks whether anyone should trust a stranger. The title hints at this lesson.	1+1+1
17	He shows Horace as polite and fond of books. The crime is small and the thief is gentle. His defeat by a rival thief makes him a pitiable victim.	1+1+1
	OR: A thief who thinks he is clever is cheated by a better actor. His trust, which he never gave to the police, is given to a thief. The result is his arrest.	1+1+1
18	Horace is an amateur who steals once a year and is gullible. The woman is a professional, quick and bold. Her skill defeats his caution.	1+1+1
	OR: Horace is in prison where he becomes the librarian. He is content among the books. The ending is humorous and also gives him peace.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define irony (1). A thief cheated (1). A lock expert fooled (1). The prison gives him peace (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Humour in character (1). Irony in plot (1). Suspense at the safe (1). Surprise ending (1). Light tone (1).	2+2+1
20	Opening (1). Horace's hasty trust (1). Consequences (1). Everyday examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: People can be both good and bad (1). Greed leads to crime (1). Trust can be exploited (1). Humour in weakness (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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